Natural Health Ministries Education Center

NHMEC Welcome & Orientation Guide

Required Orientation for All Students, Members & Learners

PENothecary™ Membership Website Learning Hub

Faith-Centered Herbal Wellness Education

Restoring the Body • Renewing the Mind • Strengthening the Spirit

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PENothecary™ Membership & Learning Hub

Welcome to NHMEC

Welcome to the Natural Health Ministries Education Center, also known as NHMEC.

We are honored to welcome you into this learning journey. Whether you are joining through the PENothecary™ Membership, enrolling in a single class, beginning a certificate, entering a diploma pathway, preparing for practitioner-level studies, or participating in volunteer training, this orientation guide is your starting place.

NHMEC exists to provide faith-centered herbal wellness education from a Christian worldview. Our purpose is to help students grow in biblical stewardship, herbal education, holistic nutrition, whole-person wellness, ministry-minded service, and responsible natural health education.

As a student, your focus is simple:

Pray. Learn. Apply. Serve.

Pray before you study.
Learn with humility.
Apply what you learn with wisdom.
Serve others with love, integrity, and responsibility.

This guide will help you understand how NHMEC works, how to access your learning materials, what is expected of you as a student, and how to move forward in your educational pathway.

Important Student Notice

Canvas Is No Longer Available

Canvas is no longer available for NHMEC.

Canvas has been completely discontinued for student access, classes, courses, assignments, videos, downloads, communication, and educational materials.

Any older NHMEC lesson, video, worksheet, PDF, or course instruction that mentions Canvas should now be considered outdated.

Students should no longer look for NHMEC materials inside Canvas.

All NHMEC educational materials are now being moved, rebuilt, organized, and housed inside the:

PENothecary™ Membership Website

The Main Education Center Hub for NHMEC

The PENothecary™ is built through Google Sites and now serves as the primary learning platform for NHMEC.

Please be patient as older modules, documents, and videos are updated. Some materials may still mention Canvas during this transition, but the current and correct learning hub is the PENothecary™.

Google Account Requirement

Because the PENothecary™ is built through Google Sites, every student must have access to a Google account or a Google-connected email account.

Students may use:

- A Gmail account
- A Google Workspace account
- A personal email that has been connected to Google

Students are responsible for making sure they can log into the correct Google account before beginning any NHMEC class, course, membership, or program.

If access is denied, students should check:

1. Am I logged into the correct Google account?
2. Is this the same email I used when I enrolled?
3. Has my access been granted yet?
4. Is my membership or enrollment active?
5. Am I trying to access a class or course that is included in my enrollment?

If help is needed, email NHMEC with:

- Your full name
- Your Google account email
- The class, course, or membership you enrolled in
- A short explanation of the issue
- A screenshot if possible

Required Orientation Policy

Every student must complete the NHMEC Welcome & Orientation before beginning any NHMEC learning pathway.

Orientation is required for:

- PENothecary™ Membership students
- Community class students
- Certificate students
- Diploma students
- Practitioner pathway students
- Registry pathway students
- Volunteer training students
- Workshop students
- Continuing education students
- Homeschool pathway students
- Specialty program students

This orientation helps every student understand:

- How NHMEC works
- How to access the PENothecary™
- Why Canvas is no longer available
- Why a Google account is required
- How to locate classes, videos, downloads, and assignments
- Student conduct expectations
- Course completion expectations
- Educational disclaimers

- Scope of practice
- Certificate and diploma policies
- Membership access
- The Holistic P.E.N. Way™
- How to begin learning with clarity

Students should complete orientation before submitting assignments or requesting a certificate, diploma, participation certificate, or registry-related review.

About NHMEC

The Natural Health Ministries Education Center was created to provide faith-centered education in herbalism, natural wellness, biblical health, holistic nutrition, and ministry-based wellness support.

NHMEC has grown from local ministry and community wellness work into an online education center with classes, courses, memberships, workshops, professional development pathways, volunteer trainings, and holistic wellness education.

NHMEC teaches students to observe the whole person through a Christian worldview.

We recognize that a person is more than a physical body. A person has:

- Spirit
- Soul
- Body

Because of this, NHMEC education looks at wellness through spiritual foundation, emotional and mental patterns, nourishment, herbs, lifestyle, family, community, and practical support.

Mission Statement

The mission of NHMEC is to provide faith-centered herbal wellness education that equips students to understand biblical stewardship, whole-person wellness, traditional herbal support, holistic nutrition, and practical wellness education for personal, family, ministry, and community use.

NHMEC exists to educate, equip, and encourage students through a Christian worldview while honoring the connection between spirit, soul, and body.

Vision Statement

The vision of NHMEC is to raise up students who are grounded in faith, wisdom, stewardship, compassion, and responsible wellness education.

NHMEC seeks to help students grow in:

- Biblical wellness
- Herbal education
- Holistic nutrition
- Natural wellness principles
- Ministry-based care
- Community service
- Practical home wellness
- Ethical herbal education
- Whole-person stewardship
- Professional development
- Continuing education

NHMEC Learning Focus

Every student should remember the NHMEC student focus:

Pray

Begin your studies with prayer. Ask God for wisdom, humility, discernment, understanding, and a teachable heart.

Learn

Study with diligence. Read the lessons, watch the videos, complete the worksheets, take notes, and review the assigned materials.

Apply

Apply what you learn responsibly. Begin with your own life, home, family, ministry, and community education within proper scope.

Serve

Use your education to bless others. Serve with humility, kindness, compassion, and integrity.

Biblical Foundation

NHMEC teaches from a Christian worldview.

We believe God created the body with design, purpose, and order. We believe that people are whole beings with spirit, soul, and body. We believe that stewardship of the body is part of honoring God.

NHMEC teaches that herbs, foods, water, rest, prayer, wise habits, and supportive lifestyle practices may support the body, but God is the ultimate healer.

Herbs do not save.
Herbs do not replace God.
Herbs do not replace medical care.
Herbs may support the body as part of God's creation, but all education must be handled with wisdom and proper boundaries.

NHMEC seeks to teach natural wellness through a biblical lens and avoid spiritual practices, rituals, teachings, or philosophies that conflict with biblical faith.

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ is the signature whole-person framework used throughout NHMEC education.

P.E.N. stands for:

P — Perspective

Perspective relates to the spirit, worldview, faith, beliefs, relationship with God, identity, hope, and how a person sees life.

Perspective asks:

- What is the spiritual foundation?
- Is the person walking in faith or fear?
- What beliefs may be shaping their choices?
- What truth, prayer, or encouragement may support them?

E — Essence

Essence relates to the soul, including thoughts, emotions, stress, identity, inner wounds, habits, mindset, and emotional patterns.

Essence asks:

- What is happening in the mind and emotions?
- Is stress affecting the person?
- Are there patterns of overwhelm, grief, fear, anger, or discouragement?
- What support may help renew the mind?

N — Nutrition

Nutrition relates to the body, including food, herbs, minerals, hydration, rest, movement, sleep, and lifestyle support.

Nutrition asks:

- Is the body nourished?
- Is the person hydrated?
- Are they resting well?
- Are herbs, foods, or lifestyle practices appropriate for education?
- Do they need referral to a licensed provider?

The Holistic P.E.N. Way™ helps students look at the whole person without stepping outside proper educational scope.

The PENothecary™ Learning Hub

The PENothecary™ Membership Website is now the main online education center hub for NHMEC.

It is built through Google Sites and houses student learning materials.

Depending on your membership or enrollment, you may find:

- Orientation materials
- Student handbook
- Course pages
- Class pages
- Video lessons
- Downloadable PDFs
- Worksheets
- Assignments
- Workshop recordings
- Herbal recipes
- Seasonal wellness guides
- Monthly classes
- Mini courses
- Professional pathway information

- Volunteer training information
- Continuing education resources
- Announcements
- Resource libraries
- Student updates

Access depends on your enrollment, membership level, class purchase, diploma pathway, or program approval.

Membership access does not automatically mean access to every NHMEC professional diploma, advanced program, or specialty course. Some programs require separate enrollment, payment, application, or approval.

How to Begin

To begin your NHMEC journey:

1. Make sure you have a Google account.
2. Complete this Welcome & Orientation Guide.
3. Read the NHMEC Student Handbook.
4. Access the PENothecary™ Learning Hub.
5. Locate your class, course, or membership area.
6. Review your course description or syllabus.
7. Download or save your required materials.
8. Create a student notebook or binder.
9. Begin with Module 1 of your assigned course.
10. Complete assignments as instructed.

Suggested Student Binder

Students are encouraged to create a binder or digital folder for their NHMEC studies.

Suggested sections:

1. Welcome & Orientation
2. Student Handbook
3. Course Syllabus
4. Notes
5. Worksheets
6. Herbal Recipes
7. Materia Medica
8. Formulary
9. Reflection Pages

10. Assignments
11. Assessments
12. Practicum Records
13. Case Studies
14. Certificates
15. Continuing Education

Keeping organized will help you track your learning and prepare for completion review.

Student Expectations

NHMEC students are expected to:

- Pray before learning
- Maintain respectful conduct
- Complete coursework within timelines
- Achieve required passing scores
- Follow NHMEC policies
- Communicate respectfully
- Submit honest work
- Stay within educational scope
- Respect copyright
- Keep student access private
- Ask for help when needed
- Use proper wellness language
- Respect instructors, students, guests, and volunteers

Students should take pride in their work, stay engaged, learn from mistakes, and approach challenges with a positive and teachable attitude.

Respectful Conduct

Students should use respectful words and actions at all times.

Respectful conduct includes:

- Kindness
- Patience
- Honesty
- Humility
- Appropriate language
- No gossip
- No harassment

- No bullying
- No threats
- No slander
- No abusive communication
- No disruptive behavior

Students should remember that their words and actions reflect their character, family, ministry, and community.

NHMEC reserves the right to remove a student from a class, membership, program, or group if conduct becomes disrespectful, unsafe, dishonest, abusive, disruptive, or harmful to the learning environment.

Academic Honesty

Students must complete their own work.

Students may use course notes, assigned readings, books, and approved resources for open-book assignments and assessments, but they should not copy another student's work or submit someone else's work as their own.

Students should not plagiarize, steal content, or misrepresent authorship.

Students may use tools for spelling, grammar, organization, and study support, but they remain responsible for understanding the material and submitting honest work.

Educational Scope

NHMEC provides education only.

NHMEC classes, courses, memberships, and materials are for informational, educational, biblical, holistic, and wellness education purposes.

NHMEC does not provide medical diagnosis, medical treatment, prescriptions, cures, or disease prevention.

NHMEC students must not claim to:

- Diagnose disease
- Treat disease
- Cure disease
- Prevent disease
- Prescribe medicine
- Prescribe herbs as treatment
- Replace medical care

- Tell others to stop medication
- Practice medicine without a license
- Use protected professional titles unlawfully
- Guarantee results

Students must remain within their proper legal and educational scope.

Proper Wellness Language

Students should use careful educational language.

Instead of saying:

“This herb cures infection.”

Say:

“This herb has traditionally been used to support the body. This information is educational and should be discussed with a licensed healthcare provider when needed.”

Instead of saying:

“You need this protocol.”

Say:

“This is an educational wellness support plan you may review and discuss with your healthcare provider.”

Instead of saying:

“Stop taking your medication.”

Say:

“Medication decisions must be discussed with your licensed healthcare provider.”

Instead of saying:

“I can diagnose what is wrong.”

Say:

“I can provide wellness education, but diagnosis must come from a licensed medical professional.”

Medical Disclaimer

The information provided through NHMEC is for educational purposes only.

It is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, prevent, or prescribe for any illness, disease, symptom, condition, or injury.

Students, members, and readers should always consult with a licensed medical provider for medical advice, diagnosis, treatment, medication questions, pregnancy, nursing, chronic illness, children's health, elderly care, mental health concerns, emergencies, or serious health issues.

NHMEC does not advise students or clients to stop medication, avoid medical care, delay medical care, or replace licensed healthcare providers.

Herbal Safety

Students must understand that herbs are not automatically safe for everyone.

Herbs may interact with:

- Medications
- Pregnancy
- Nursing
- Surgery
- Medical conditions
- Allergies
- Children
- Elderly individuals
- Autoimmune conditions
- Liver or kidney concerns
- Blood pressure conditions
- Blood sugar conditions
- Mental health medications
- Blood thinning medications

Students should always research safety, contraindications, preparation methods, dosage traditions, and interactions.

When in doubt, refer to a licensed healthcare provider.

When to Refer to a Licensed Provider

Students should refer someone to a licensed healthcare provider when:

- Symptoms are severe
- Symptoms are new or unexplained
- Symptoms are worsening
- There is chest pain
- There is trouble breathing
- There is fainting, confusion, or sudden weakness
- There is bleeding
- There may be a medical emergency
- The person is pregnant or nursing
- The person is a child, elderly, or medically fragile
- The person has a serious diagnosis
- The person takes medication
- The person needs diagnosis, testing, labs, imaging, or medical treatment

NHMEC education should never be used to delay urgent or necessary medical care.

Certificates, Diplomas & Completion Recognition

NHMEC may issue several types of educational recognition.

Certificate of Participation

A Certificate of Participation may be given for community classes, workshops, volunteer trainings, or events where the learner participates but does not complete a full certificate or diploma program.

Certificate of Completion

A Certificate of Completion may be awarded when a student completes a class or certificate-level training with required lessons, assignments, and assessments.

Diploma of Completion

A Diploma of Completion may be awarded when a student completes a larger program of study or course pathway. Diploma programs may include modules, assignments, readings, assessments, final exams, projects, practicums, case studies, or portfolios.

Continuing Education

Some NHMEC classes or workshops may count as continuing education through NHMEC.

Registry Recognition

Some eligible graduates may apply for NHMEC registry recognition if they complete the required program, ethics, continuing education, review, and membership requirements.

All certificates, diplomas, and recognitions represent educational completion. They do not grant medical licensure or permission to practice any regulated profession.

Course Levels

NHMEC learning may include several levels.

Community Level

Beginner-friendly education for the general public, families, churches, community groups, or ministry outreach.

Certificate Level

Focused classes that provide structured learning and may include assignments, worksheets, quizzes, or projects.

Applied Level

Intermediate training that helps students apply knowledge through projects, planning, demonstrations, or community education.

Diploma Level

Larger programs of study with deeper readings, assignments, assessments, and final completion requirements.

Practitioner Pathway

Advanced learning pathways that may include case studies, practicum work, documentation, ethics, professional language, and a final portfolio.

Specialty Programs

Focused advanced programs in a specialized area of herbal wellness, biblical wellness, adaptive regulation, family wellness, community service, or professional development.

PENothecary™ Membership

The PENothecary™ Membership is the main NHMEC membership learning hub.

Depending on current membership offerings, the PENothecary™ may include:

- Monthly classes
- Mini courses
- Seasonal workshops
- Downloadable PDFs
- Herbal recipes
- Wellness challenges
- Educational videos
- Workshop recordings
- Digital magazine resources
- Community education
- Student updates
- Member-only content
- Continuing education opportunities

Membership access is based on active membership status.

Membership materials are for the enrolled member only and should not be shared, copied, sold, or redistributed.

Community Membership vs Student Enrollment

A community member may participate in general classes, monthly learning, mini lessons, workshops, downloads, and participation-based education.

A student enrollment may involve a specific class, certificate, course, diploma, professional pathway, or program with assignments, assessments, and completion recognition.

Membership access and student enrollment may overlap, but they are not always the same.

Some classes or diploma programs may require separate enrollment even if a person is a PENothecary™ member.

Accreditation & Third-Party Agencies

🌿 Institutional Recognition
Penny Lane Whittemore is recognized as an:

ICAHP Accredited Holistic Training Provider
Through the International Compliance Assurance for Holistic Practitioners (ICAHP)
Since November 2024

This accreditation reflects private holistic education standards and curriculum review within the natural health education field.

ICAHP accreditation:

• Recognizes structured holistic education programs
• Reflects compliance with private holistic training standards
• Does not constitute state licensure
• Does not represent regional academic accreditation
• Does not grant medical or healthcare authority

ICAHP is a private accrediting organization within the holistic education sector and is distinct from government or medical regulatory agencies.

🌿 Accreditation & Institutional Status
Natural Health Ministries Education Center (NHMEC)
Last Updated: 2026

Natural Health Ministries Education Center (NHMEC) operates as a private, faith-based educational institution specializing in structured herbal and holistic wellness education.

This section clarifies NHMEC's institutional status and accreditation relationships.

🌿 Institutional Structure
NHMEC is:

• A privately operated educational institution
• Faith-based in orientation
• Independently governed
• Structured with internal academic progression standards

NHMEC is not:

• A state university
• A government-regulated medical school
• A healthcare licensing board
• A state-approved medical training institution

🌿 Educational Nature of All Programs
All NHMEC programs are educational in scope.

Completion of any program:

• Does not grant medical licensure
• Does not authorize medical diagnosis or treatment
• Does not permit prescription of pharmaceuticals
• Does not replace licensed healthcare training

Students are responsible for understanding the laws governing wellness education and practice in their jurisdiction.

NHMEC may hold training provider recognition, accreditation, memberships, or approvals through third-party organizations.

Students should understand that training provider recognition does not equal state licensure.

Third-party certification, board certification, membership, registration, or designation is determined solely by the third-party organization.

NHMEC does not guarantee that any outside agency, employer, insurance provider, school, professional organization, or board will accept a student, graduate, course, certificate, diploma, or transcript.

Students are responsible for reviewing all outside requirements before assuming eligibility.

Completion Timelines

Students should complete their programs within the stated timeline.

General guidelines:

- Certificate classes should generally be completed within 6 months.
- Diploma courses should generally be completed within 2 years.
- Practitioner-level programs may allow 3 to 4 years depending on the program.
- Membership-based materials are available according to active membership access.
- Workshops and mini classes may have shorter timelines.

Students who need extra time due to exceptional circumstances may submit a written extension request.

Extension approval is not guaranteed.

Failure to complete a course within the assigned time may result in loss of student status, loss of access, and loss of payments already made.

Assessments

NHMEC assessments may include:

- Open-book quizzes
- Final exams
- Reflections
- Worksheets
- Projects
- Practicums
- Case studies
- Portfolios
- Oral reviews
- Student agreements

The general minimum passing score is 70% unless a specific class, course, or program requires a higher score.

Some professional or advanced pathways may require 80% or higher.

Students who do not pass may be allowed to review the material and retake the assessment according to course policy.

Refund Policy Summary

Refund policies may vary depending on the class, course, membership, kit, or program.

General policies:

- Membership fees are non-refundable.
- Registration fees are non-refundable.
- Donation-based classes are non-refundable.
- Digital products, PDFs, videos, downloads, and course access are non-refundable.
- Sliding fee scale payments are non-refundable.
- Individual course units are non-refundable once access is granted.
- Eligible courses may allow up to a 90% refund within 3 days of enrollment.
- No refunds are available after the 3-day period.
- Shipping fees are non-refundable once an item has shipped.
- Physical kits may have separate policies.

Students should read the specific course or membership policy before enrolling.

Copyright & Use of Materials

NHMEC materials are protected educational content.

Students may not:

- Copy materials for distribution
- Sell NHMEC materials
- Share private links
- Upload materials publicly
- Give downloads to non-students
- Repackage NHMEC lessons as their own
- Use NHMEC curriculum to create competing courses
- Remove copyright notices
- Use NHMEC branding without permission

Students may:

- Print materials for personal study
- Save downloads for personal educational use
- Keep a student binder
- Use worksheets for their own assignments
- Keep a student portfolio

Written permission is required for any use beyond personal study.

Technology Responsibilities

Students are responsible for having the technology needed to complete online learning.

Students may need:

- Internet access
- Google account
- Device that can open Google Sites
- Ability to open PDFs
- Ability to view videos
- Ability to download or print worksheets
- Email access
- Ability to participate in online meetings if required

NHMEC is not responsible for a student’s device issues, forgotten passwords, internet problems, Google account problems, or inability to use basic technology.

Students should seek help when needed.

Communication Expectations

Students should communicate respectfully and clearly.

When contacting NHMEC, include:

- Full name
- Google account email
- Class, course, or membership title
- Description of the issue
- Screenshot if possible
- Date of enrollment if helpful
- Payment or registration name if different

Students should allow reasonable response time.

Rude, demanding, harassing, or disrespectful communication may delay support or result in loss of access.

Study-o-pedia & Resource Library Disclaimer

NHMEC may provide resource lists, links, PDFs, books, public domain materials, research articles, monographs, handouts, or outside educational resources.

These resources are provided for study and reference only.

Some outside resources may include language, theories, modalities, or viewpoints that do not fully represent NHMEC's Christian worldview.

Students are encouraged to use discernment.

Take what is useful for learning, compare it with scripture, evaluate safety, and leave what does not align with biblical faith or NHMEC principles.

NHMEC does not necessarily endorse every statement, author, organization, modality, or viewpoint found in outside resources.

Student Success Tips

To succeed as an NHMEC student:

- Complete orientation first.
- Read the Student Handbook.
- Pray before studying.
- Keep a notebook or binder.
- Set a weekly study schedule.
- Save your downloads.
- Watch lessons completely.
- Complete assignments on time.
- Ask questions respectfully.
- Keep your scope clear.
- Use proper wellness language.
- Track your progress.
- Save all certificates.
- Continue learning after completion.

Suggested Weekly Study Rhythm

Students may follow a simple weekly rhythm:

Day 1

Watch the lesson video or read the lesson.

Day 2

Review notes and required readings.

Day 3

Complete the worksheet or reflection.

Day 4

Study herbs, terms, or assigned concepts.

Day 5

Complete assignment or quiz.

Day 6

Review, organize notes, and pray over what was learned.

Day 7

Rest, catch up, or prepare for the next module.

Closing Welcome

Welcome to NHMEC.

You are not just beginning a class. You are beginning a journey of faith-centered learning, stewardship, wisdom, and service.

May your studies be guided by prayer, strengthened by discipline, and used for the good of your family, ministry, community, and calling.

Remember:

Pray. Learn. Apply. Serve.